1. What restrictions apply if you're towing a trailer on a three-lane motorway?

A. You must not overtake

B. You must not exceed 50 mph

C. You must not use the right-hand lane

D. You must have a stabiliser fitted

2. What should you do if you're towing a trailer and it starts to swing from side to side?

A. Let go of the steering wheel and let it correct itself

B. Ease off the accelerator to reduce your speed

C. Accelerate until it stabilises

D. Brake hard and hold the pedal down

3. When would you increase the pressure in your tyres so that it's above the normal value?

A. When the tyre tread is worn below 2 mm

B. When the roads are slippery

C. When carrying a heavy load

D. When the vehicle is fitted with anti-lock brakes

4. How will a heavy load on your roof rack affect your vehicle's handling?

A. It will make the steering lighter

B. It will improve the road holding

C. It will reduce the stopping distance

D. It will reduce stability

5. What would be affected if you carry a very heavy load on your vehicle?

A. The vehicle's gearbox

B. The vehicle's battery

C. The vehicle's handling

D. The vehicle's ventilation

6. Who's responsible for making sure that a vehicle isn't overloaded?

A. The driver of the vehicle

B. The owner of the items being carried

C. The person who loaded the vehicle

D. The licensing authority

7. You're planning to tow a caravan. What will help the handling of the combination?

A. A stabiliser fitted to the tow bar

B. Anti-lock brakes fitted to the towing vehicle

C. Power steering fitted to the towing vehicle

D. A jockey wheel fitted to the tow bar

8. Are passengers allowed to ride in a caravan that's being towed?

A. No, not at any time

B. Yes, if they're over 14

C. Only if a stabiliser is fitted

D. Only if all the seats in the towing vehicle are full

9. What safety device must be fitted to a trailer braking system?

A. Corner steadies

B. Stabiliser

C. Jockey wheel

D. Breakaway cable

10. You wish to tow a trailer. Where would you find the maximum noseweight for your vehicle's tow hitch?

A. In The Highway Code

B. In your licence documents

C. In the vehicle handbook

D. In your vehicle registration certificate

11. How should a load be carried on your roof rack?

A. Securely fastened with suitable restraints

B. Loaded towards the rear of the vehicle

C. Visible in your exterior mirror

D. Covered with plastic sheeting

12. You're carrying a child under three years old in your car. Which restraint is suitable for a child of this age?

A. A child seat

B. An adult lap belt

C. An adult seat belt

D. An adult holding a child

13. You've just passed your driving test. What's the maximum authorised mass (MAM) of any trailer that you can tow?

A. 6,500 kg

B. 3,500 kg

C. 4,500 kg

D. 5,500 kg

14. What should you do before you tow a trailer for the first time?

A. Ask DVLA to update your licence

B. Pass a special driving test

C. Take professional training

D. Fit P plates to your trailer

15. You're going to tow a trailer that's wider than your car. What must you fit to your car before you start towing it?

A. Exterior towing mirrors

B. Projection markers

C. Parking sensors

D. Rear-view camera

16. What must you do when you hitch an unbraked trailer to a towing vehicle?

A. Make sure you can see the trailer in the mirrors

B. Grease the tow ball and hitch

C. Switch off the reversing sensor on the towing vehicle

D. Fit a secondary coupling device

17. What's the minimum depth of tread on the tyres of a trailer?

A. 2.2 mm

B. 1 mm

C. 1.6 mm

D. 2 mm

18. You're about to start a journey towing a trailer. What should you do if you notice that a light on your trailer is not working?

A. Continue with your journey because the lights on your car are working

B. Disconnect the trailer electrical coupling before continuing with your journey

C. Repair the fault before continuing with your journey

D. Book the trailer in for repair before continuing with your journey

19. What does it mean if your trailer has a maximum authorised mass (MAM) of 3,500 kg?

A. Your empty trailer weighs 3,500 kg

B. Your trailer can carry a load of 3,500 kg

C. Your trailer and load combined cannot weigh more than 3,500 kg

D. Your trailer and towing vehicle combined cannot weigh more than 3,500 kg

20. What should you do if your trailer starts to swerve or snake?

A. Reduce speed gently

B. Brake firmly

C. Increase speed

D. Steer sharply

21. How should you load your trailer?

A. Put heavy items at the front

B. Put heavy items at the back

C. Put heavy items over the axle(s)

D. Put heavy items in the corners

Answers

1. C - You must not use the right-hand lane

The motorway regulations for towing a trailer state that you must not • use the right-hand lane of a three-lane motorway unless directed to do so (for example, at roadworks or due to a lane closure) • exceed 60 mph.

2. B - Ease off the accelerator to reduce your speed

Strong winds or buffeting from large vehicles can cause a trailer or caravan to swing from side to side ('snake'). If this happens, ease off the accelerator. Don’t brake harshly, steer sharply or increase your speed.

3. C - When carrying a heavy load

Check the vehicle handbook. This should give you guidance on the correct tyre pressures for your vehicle and when you may need to adjust them. If you’re carrying a heavy load, you may need to adjust the headlights as well. Most cars have a switch on the dashboard to do this.

4. D - It will reduce stability

A heavy load on your roof rack will reduce the stability of the vehicle because it moves the centre of gravity away from that designed by the manufacturer. Be aware of this when you drive round bends and corners. If you change direction at speed, your vehicle and/or load could become unstable and you could lose control.

5. C - The vehicle's handling

Any load will have an effect on the handling of your vehicle, and this becomes worse as you increase the load. You need to be aware of this when carrying passengers or heavy loads, fitting a roof rack or towing a trailer.

6. A - The driver of the vehicle

Carrying heavy loads will affect control and the vehicle's handling characteristics. If the vehicle you're driving is overloaded, you'll be held responsible.

7. A - A stabiliser fitted to the tow bar

Towing a caravan or trailer affects the way the towing vehicle handles. A stabiliser device isn't designed to overcome instability caused by incorrect loading but it can give added security in side winds and from buffeting caused by large vehicles.

8. A - No, not at any time

Riding in a towed caravan is highly dangerous. The safety of the entire unit is dependent on the stability of the trailer. Moving passengers would make the caravan unstable and could cause loss of control.

9. D - Breakaway cable

In the event that the trailer becomes detached from the towing vehicle, the breakaway cable activates the trailer brakes before snapping. This allows the towing vehicle to get free of the trailer and out of danger.

10. C - In the vehicle handbook

You must know how to load your trailer or caravan so that the hitch exerts an appropriate downward force on the tow ball. Information about the maximum permitted noseweight can be found in your vehicle handbook or obtained from your vehicle manufacturer’s agent.

11. A - Securely fastened with suitable restraints

Any load must be securely fastened to the vehicle. The safest way to carry items on the roof is in a specially designed roof box. This will help to keep your luggage secure and dry, and it also has less wind resistance than loads carried exposed on a roof rack.

12. A - A child seat

It’s your responsibility to ensure that all children in your car are secure. Suitable restraints include a child seat, baby seat, booster seat or booster cushion. It’s essential that any restraint used is suitable for the child’s size and weight, and fitted according to the manufacturer’s instructions.

13. B - 3,500 kg

When you pass your driving test, you're allowed to tow a trailer up to 3,500 kg MAM without taking an extra test. If you want to tow a heavier trailer, you'll have to pass either a CE or DE category test, dependent on the towing vehicle.

14. C - Take professional training

You need to know how to tow a trailer safely. This includes hitching the trailer to your vehicle, checking the trailer for defects, reversing with a trailer and how to deal with any problems. There are accredited trainers who can teach you these skills. Professional training will also give you confidence in your ability to tow a trailer safely.

15. A - Exterior towing mirrors

You must fit exterior towing mirrors to your vehicle if • your vehicle is narrower than your trailer or load • your trailer or load obstructs the view behind you.

16. D - Fit a secondary coupling device

If a tow hitch fails, the trailer must stay connected to the towing vehicle. This is achieved by using a secondary coupling device, such as a safety chain.

17. C - 1.6 mm

Your car or small van must have a minimum tread depth of 1.6 mm across the centre of the tread and around the entire circumference. This also applies to the tyres on your trailer.

18. C - Repair the fault before continuing with your journey

You must make sure that your vehicle and trailer are roadworthy. Check that your tyres are legal, and the brakes and lights are working properly. If any of these things are not working, you must not drive or tow your trailer until the fault is repaired.

19. C - Your trailer and load combined cannot weigh more than 3,500 kg

The MAM of the trailer is stamped on the plate fitted to the chassis. It is the maximum weight of the trailer and load that the manufacturer has designed it to carry. Do not load your trailer so that it exceeds this maximum weight.

20. A - Reduce speed gently

If your trailer starts to swerve or snake, reduce speed gently to regain control. Do not accelerate or brake harshly.

21. C - Put heavy items over the axle(s)

When loading your trailer, you should spread the weight evenly with heavy items over the axle(s). This should reduce the risk of it swerving or snaking.